

Welcome everybody to an FMCG, guys, live session on LinkedIn or if later we'll probably probably think this as a podcast. So if you're listening it later as a podcast, welcome. You can also watch this one on our YouTube channel. We'll leave the link in the show notes. I'm very excited to be here accompanied by my dear cohost Christine Nicolaou to speak about and two very selected guests, of course, to speak about one of the hottest topics in the in our industry today, agentic commerce.

Let's go into it. Christine, why do you think this topic is relevant?

Oh, I didn't expect that you would be asking me questions. Hi, Daniel. I'm super happy to be here and doing this live with everyone.

Well, I have to say, I remember that we were in ShopTalk, and I was going through all the buzzwords of, like, okay. What was the words we were hearing all over ShopTalk? And Adjentic, I think, was number one. We even did, like, a little bit of a definition on our page on LinkedIn. So if there is one word that I think that everybody's still trying to figure out why it's important, how the hell is this important for my business, it's definitely a genetic commerce for twenty twenty five and twenty twenty six.

Yeah. For sure. So we're accompanied, they said, by two selected guests and by the audience live, which audience, by the way, do will will do the following. You can drop us questions as we go, and we may answer them while we go if they're we think they're relevant.

I'll decide, basically. And if not, we we can cover some at the end of the session. But let's introduce our guests. On one side, we have Beza Kapu, who's the global e com tech and data analytics director at L'Oreal.

Hi, Beza. How are you?

Hello. Great to be here with you today. How about you?

Very good. Very good. And on the other side, we have a repeat guest on our live series. It's no other than Salim Banchaden, who's the SVP sales ecommerce in the in IQ. How are you?

Yeah. I'm feeling like a kind of cohost now, like, with this webinar. So yeah. Very promoted.

It's a it's a I think it's a great topic. I am happy for many reasons. The topic is amazing.

I think it's one of those topics where we probably don't have all the answers, but we're gonna talk. And I'm also happy because Beza is here.

I value a lot her point of view about the topic, so I'm sure it's gonna be a great conversation.

Yes. You're grateful.

It it's a fantastic topic.

We discussed why it's important, but perhaps we can start with the very, very basic of it. Like, what is it? Like, what is it that we're discussing here today? What is authentic commerce? I don't know. Like, Bisa, would you like to kick us off and tell a little bit about the topic?

Yeah. I would love to, and I would like to take a bit of time here if you allow me.

Because I think when people hear agency commerce, they often immediately think of shopping bots or autonomous buying. And I think there is also a confusion between three different layers. The first layer, I would say AI assisted commerce. That's where AI helps you search better, filter better, compare better, and summarize better. And the consumer in this part is still in the control of the journey, but the process becomes much easier.

The second layer, I would say AI mediated commerce. That's where AI becomes the first things interface between the market and the consumer. The consumer here is no longer, you know, navigating, you know, the retailer, search engine, or marketplace directly, and they're going through a system, like the AI systems, that interprets needs and frames options. So that's the second one, I would say. And the third layer is what we call now agent e commerce. This is when the system doesn't only interpret and recommend, but actually begins to act, shortlisting, bundling, automating, reordering, initiating steps, and eventually, at one state stage perhaps purchasing on consumer's behalf. However, honestly, I want to take a step back for a moment here to, set a bit the basis because what I think happening now is that happening in a larger human transformation.

Because, you know, we're moving from a world where people actively search, compare, filter, and decide along to a world where they increasingly describe their needs and ask help to the systems, you know, in their decision and in their thinking. Why? So that's a very important distinction for me because this shift is not only manual shopping to automated shopping. This shift is from individual cognition to, I would say, more, automated, assisted cognition.

So if you look how people are really using AI today, you would understand this because they're not only using, AI for asking product recommendation. We're asking it about, you know, the the health, life, work, personal situations, emotional problems, even some questions that we don't dare to ask to another, human being. You know? So these systems are becoming more closer to a companion, thinking partner, decision aid.

And once a system becomes something you trust to reduce complexity in your life that much, honestly, commerce initially becomes one of the domains where you also allow the system to intervene easily. So for me, agent e commerce, if you look from that perspective, is just not better recommendation, hyper personalization, better UX,

name it. It's the moment where AI starts carrying part of the the cognitive burden that's that's happening in the commerce world today. Because let's face it, modern consumers are today overwhelmed.

There's too much information, too much distraction, too much, choice, too much friction, and we don't want that infant options anymore. You know? We want less noise, more relevance, more confidence, and that's why I think it's finding its place in the market. So for me in that sense, if you think from that broader perspective, it's not a commerce shift.

It's a decision making shift. And if I have to define now in one line, I would say agent commerce is the moment where AI moves from helping people search to helping people think, decide, and act. That's why I think it's very important what we're talking here.

Yeah.

Go ahead, Sunny.

I wanted to jump that. I so first of all, I this is a great and I think it will this is something we should we should keep as a as a, like, as an industry in terms of how to look at this as a bigger thing than what we potentially think it is.

Also, it would help, I think, manufacturers and the whole ecosystem to get ready. So I would say, like, for me, from a very short terms point of view, there's one keyword I would I would state is delegation.

Yeah.

So it's basically delegating the the the decision to an AI. And as soon as you start to think of it this way, it changes completely the narrative. We're moving from my search, I compare, and then I choose, which Beza described as the burden of making a

decision to you know, the AI will choose, and I will approve. So I'm kind of delegating the ability to choose.

And what is this triggered? I think that is the second keyword I would use is the personalization. So we share so much as companions with with, like, those agents that at some point, they are really able to reflect with us on, like, what to choose in terms of, like, our shopping decisions. And therefore, it's not like the the the the future would be made of shopper not being the primary decision factor, so the AI will.

And as soon as we recognize and accept and integrate this, the story becomes very different for manufacturers, for retailers, for the entire ecosystem.

And then do you think is this is, like, for now, merely philosophical, or do you see it in your own, like, shopping habits and your own personal behaviors?

I I see it I see it so I see it from myself in the way I interact with the different agents. So, you know, obviously, you cannot so imagine if you're trying to buy and, obviously, there is a difference in categories between tech and durable and more like grocery kind of products.

But now I it's opening my perspective on much broader kind of inputs that I haven't thought of. So I feel it's helping me to broaden and then narrow it down to fewer decision points.

So so I don't think it's philosophical. I think it's it's it's really true.

Yeah. And, like, thinking also about myself. Right? I use AI a lot, and I will not necessarily be like, oh, hey.

Yeah. AI. Help me find the product which does this, this, and that. No. It's like a whole story.

You have things that you're trying to solve in your life, and eventually, it might lead to, like, a product that you use. But okay. Like, let's say, our personal habits are changing and sober habits are changing as well.

There are millions of ways that this can impact kind of, like, the retailers and the FMCG brands. From your side, guys, where you where would you say, like, the main challenges are coming right now?

Well, I think the challenge for FMCG brand and the retailers, of course, is huge because, you know, the brand strength, traditional go to market models, you know, the the engagement models, digital strategies are no longer alone enough. So in AI mediated world, your product has to be understood, trusted, and recommendable by a system, not just recognized by a consumer. Right? So the agency commerce introduces another audience in our world, machines. And this has another requirement, being legible to a machine. That's a big challenge for I will talk from an FMCG portfolio, FMCG port perspective first because, you know, our portfolios are large, fragmented, multi market, multi retailer, and often inconsistent in how product data and content are managed with, of course, additional local complexities, legacy operating models. So humans have always found a way to compensate this inconsistencies in some ways and fill those gaps, you know, but machines don't.

So the real shift is from being visible everywhere to being interpretable, recommendable everywhere. And this is a both data challenge and organizational challenge challenge. Sorry. And I think there's also a new risk, which is risk of invisibility.

Because if you're not in the answer, you are effectively not in the market. And that's much harsher form of, I would say, competitive exclusion.

Yeah. I think I I I, of course, agree. So for me, it's it's also a nightmare.

Be it's and I agree that it's organizational potentially human and organizational more than anything else.

Why? Because, like, the the ways of working have been established for decades around some principles that that are very simple. Like, I'm looking for visibility. I'm looking for impulse.

I'm looking, like, at the packaging, at the PDP. I'm looking at the brand equity and so on and so forth. So all of that was done as a way to market the human brain. So and now we're not marketing with the with the agent ecommerce.

We are basically qualifying for an LLM.

So it changes entirely the story in how we work as as marketers towards, you know, achieving our objective, moving from what I said as, like, marketing a human brain to to basically feeding an LLM in the right way. And I agree that it's it's almost binary. Like, you know, we're moving from, like, the consideration like, the ten products. Like, I need to find my way through the products and make a decision to a very narrower list of recommendations that I need to qualify or disqualify as a final shopper. And sometimes, we're gonna move to a point where the purchase is gonna be automated too, and we need to be to get ready. So I think for FMCG brands, it's it's mostly organizational outside.

And and that's where most most of our conversations with clients are about is how do you kind of ignite that right change of ways of working and organizations to shift and be adapted to to what's gonna happen or what's happening already.

Yeah. By the way, because I see I see there are a lot of people because I have my phone here. I'm looking at people that have registered, and I'm I know we're, like, double the people we were when we started. So I just want to remind people that we're here. We're the FMCG guys, and we're speaking with Beza Kapu from L'Oreal

and Salim Bachidin from Nielsen IQ on agentic commerce. And that you can actually ask us questions directly by leaving your comment in the comment section.

Somebody Ashwini said that she loved the articulation of individual cognition to to assisted cognition as an agentic.

Yeah. What I think one interesting thing is that basically, like, I think that brand building was built on the assumption that consumers would take the decisions in the supermarket and think this is changing a lot. What I should speaking of supermarkets, what I I mean, retailers are actually building, like, some kind of internal solutions now as well to, like, bring AI to the retailers. I don't know if that can be effective in any way or have an impact.

I Do you wanna go first, Bezel?

I can start. Well, actually, retailers are not watching this. It's they are actively participating and even designing this transformation, I would say. And what retailers are doing is not random experimentation, I can assure you.

This is not just about technology adoption. I think they're trying to answer a very strategic question here. If discovery becomes conversational, which we see that it's happening, who owns then this conversational layer? It's about redefining who owns the customer relationship trust in AI first journey.

Right? And let's face it, they still have a huge advantage. They have first party shopping data, behavioral history, inventory depth, logistic infrastructure, high purchase frequency. They know consumer, product environment.

They know the brands. They know the companies. They control the fulfillment layer. That all matters a lot.

You know? But at the same time, we know that they're also open and sending some signals of openness because some of them are also open to, I would say, working



with the third party agents over time, assuming the experience and the value exchange will improve. Right? So the story, think, is not a simple position.

It's most probably negotiation of who owns discovery, who owns customer content, and how value gets, I would say, shared.

And Google is also, by the way, Meta is also very important players here. So if I would say, zoom out and look from retailers perspective what they are doing, I think they're doing three things. First, definitely, they're trying to bring conversational discovery close to commerce parts. Second, they're trying to prove economic impact. Every week we are hearing from, you know, Sparky that, you know, it increases the basket value thanks to the AI assisted journey. And third, meanwhile, they're also trying to defend or I would say extend their role in a world where discovery may no longer begin on their own surfaces.

Yeah. I think that this is probably the biggest, not threat, but shift in the path to purchase. So so I agree that, like, retailers are trying to ensure that, you know, the AI will choose within their own ecosystem.

The reality, yeah, but the reality is that it's it's hard. It's harder because Bezal talked about the third party vendors that are playing an important role, so ChatGPT, Gemini, and and the others.

And I think it would be it would be super hard. So there are as, like, you know, news almost on weekly basis, seeing, like, more openness even with the retailers' agents trying to open to wider than just the the ecosystem to capture that kind of traffic.

I think, you know, the partnership between Walmart and ChatGPT is a key also information information in the market about how all of this is potentially going to converge.

I think, you know, I think we will there were many announcements like ChatGPT partnership with Shopify allowing, you know, in app purchase with some kind of d two c websites or Etsy and so on and so forth. So I think there would be more of this.

So so I think what retailers are doing, they are trying to move fast but careful because I think it's seen as something that can disrupt massively, like, the existing role of a of a of a of a retailer. But I think the the key point here is that everyone recognizes that the data, the PDP becomes the structural point that would be used by these LLMs. And I think, potentially, this is the biggest mission for retailers is, you know, the the data, like, the PDP into a kind of structured knowledge source in a way that, like, the right products are recommended and so on and so forth. So so, yeah, that's my kind of point of view is potentially a convergence of everything we're seeing and a kind of more blurry lines between retailers' agents and, you know, third party agents.

But but the retailers don't really have don't really know.

Like, they don't know, like, okay. You can be retailer x and decide, okay. You're gonna do the PDP like this, and all your products on our website are gonna be like this, but they have, like, no kind of control over, like, all the other retailers they listed in and so on. Like, doesn't this, like, break the the the fact?

Yeah. But that's why the content now it's like these are the right questions to be asked. So I was reading earlier, and and I'm sure we will talk about this later on about, like, the importance of content.

But, yeah, feeding an LLM with contradictory data is basically what kills the LLM recommendation. So, yeah, there will be a need of, like, more harmonization. I don't know how this would go. But, yeah, it would bring the right questions in my point of view.

But let's discuss a little bit the content. Right? But coming from a brand point of view, also, was like, I've been enrolled in ecommerce, and we're like, okay. Let's get the title right, and then these keywords that need to go in the subscription and then the picture.

Right? Let's have the power images because the human brain is like, I'm to decide in five seconds, and now there's no human brain. Right? There is an AI that's going on these pages and staking information.

How do we win the digital self?

So I'm glad you stated the word digital self. So because so the reason I'm I'm happy, and I think it's it's probably the the happiest moment in my journey within this space, It's finally finally, we're gonna look so I think digital self will be more important than it had ever been in the past.

We were recommending, yeah, for beauty, for attracting, like, the shopper eyes, and now it's completely different. And I think for those who are doing this as a task, like, okay. I just need to have, like, five words length to respect the retailer rules and, you know, whatever keywords inserted in a very messy way in the PDP, that's, like, gone now. Now it's it's not about how beautiful is the image.

It's about, you know, is the is the is the PDP addressing the context of what I wanna position to an LLM so that I maximize my chances to be recommended. So I think, you know, you can do as much efforts as possible. But if if you don't get that element right, and I don't think it's just the content piece of digital self. So I'll give you just one perspective.

You're talking to ChatGPT. You you have a conversation about getting a recommendation to buy a product, and then, you know, you move to a retailer website

to, you know, go effectively do your purchase. And then suddenly, the ratings and reviews are not as good.

The price actually, and as you search for that product, there's another product that was sponsored, popped up at the same time that has better price, better, you know, delivery or shipping times and and better ratings and reviews. I potentially might lose that opportunity. So I was recommended by an LLM, but then moving to the retail ecosystem, I lost the the the add to basket because I was not optimized in my in my digital self. So that's why now I think the focus on digital shelf becomes even more important to make sure that the path to purchase is, like, is frictionless.

I'm not going to play a lot on being recommended, but then eventually losing it for all the elements of digital. But then narrowing it down to more of the content, I think every single content matters. So PDP, critical, brand websites, d two c websites, Wikipedia, You know, everywhere and forums, obviously, where shoppers are talking about the value of a product and what it brings and and so on and so forth. So I think it brings a new potentially a new kind of roles, which is trying to find consistency between the different sources of content that sit in the web and making sure that everything is kind of aligned.

So we're not introducing discrepancies to an LLM, which would disqualify the brand by essence because LLM hates, like, you know, discordant messages on a on a similar product.

I will do double click on what you're saying, of the parts you were saying, Salim, not because, you know, you're my favorite partner in terms of the digital shelf solution, but actually, really, think so. And, you know, the whole hundred percent aligned and agree what you say. But there's also one another angle of that one. Digital shelf used to be mainly as a retailer execution discipline.

Right? And most of the time, it stayed in the lower part of the funnel when we think of that of that. Now in the AI era, as you were saying, Christine, assets like how your PDP looks, whether your image are rendered incorrect, whether your bullets, attributes are complete, taxonomy, availability, content structure, descriptions, name it. All these are no longer just retail execution because now you have three audience.

You have steel shoppers, you have search algorithms, and you have now the machine. Right? And the the part they part of they they teach what the product is, what is good for, and when it should be recommended. They're all part of the system that teaches the AI how your product will be discovered.

So digital shelf becomes part of conversation at different levels. So that's why it is really, really important. It's becoming more upper part of the funnel. By the way, we didn't talk about the funnel, but funnel is collapsing, actually.

It's getting compressed. Right? Because now everything from the discovery to comparison to evolution to validation to execution, decision, action, everything is happening in conversation in a different mood, changing from one to another from the shopper perspective in a very short time period. And digital shelf is definitely is something at the basics that affect different parts of this journey.

So it's not only, I would say, source anymore. It's part of the conversation at these different levels. But I also need to emphasize that it's it's not only digital shelf for sure. It goes outside the PDP, and it this is the the most challenging part actually that big companies are facing now.

It can pull from brand website, editorial content, community conversations, public forums, and possibly other structured sources. Right? So, actually, I would say digital shelf becoming more important, but no longer sufficient on its own. So you have to be controlled everywhere.

You don't have one product story to tell anymore in one, I would say, platform. So I think that has a major consequence for brands, I would say.

Yeah. And from what you guys are saying, if I'm hearing correctly, it's both on content that the brand or retailer owns, but as well as user generated content is that just lives on the web on its own, and now you need to make sure that you have your eye on it.

Yeah. The brands that win will be the ones that understand those both and ensure consistency and coherence across all different systems.

So Yeah.

I want I wanted to add a point on claims. So, you know, product claims, basically.

Oh, big one.

Yeah. No. Because, you know, at some point, it's not anymore, like, a two or three dimension kind of story. It has multiple. Like, it will push the reflection for what kind of claims I'm gonna put next to my product. I'm gonna have to go deeper, not just, like, at the surface level.

And I think it would push reflection of brand teams on how and the like, for me, one of the ways for them to do that is to understand also what shoppers are looking for. So when I look at the first initial sets of data that we have around, you know, the patterns of conversations, what people are talking about in a specific category, Sometimes you have, like, you have some topics that are being discussed, which are not claimed by some products that could be claimed. So I think that's where we trigger, like, a conversation with our manufacturer clients and partners around, like, are you sure you have explored and exploited everything within your assortment?

And and you could be optimizing even better. So it's a and this could be helped by AI, by the way, just, like, staying within the AI framework. No. It's like those are big

questions, I think, that should be triggered at the moment within within our manufacturer clients.

Yeah. There's so many many moving pieces, and and and I think it's compulsory to ask. By the way, speaking of asking, we do have a lot of quite a lot of questions coming in from our audience. So we will cover them, keep them coming.

But what what's happening with retail media in this because I know before we all spoke about Agendaq and AI, we were all talking about retail media in this industry. Is that becoming less relevant and and companies should? Because you said before, Salim, that it's an organizational thing. It's one of the organizational things.

Retail media networks don't kill me. Does that mean they should not invest so much in retail media and and reinvest in other channels? What does that mean?

Wait. I'm gonna save them. Don't worry. It's not going anywhere in anywhere.

Thank you. Thank you.

It will have to evolve quite significantly, though, and there's opportunity. Historically, commerce media, know, the retail media work through, you know, visible placement, ranking, search ads, sponsored products, display banners, name it. In a AI environment, the model becomes, I'd say, less straightforward because the interface is conversational. So the user expectation is obviously different.

Right? In a conversational environment, people don't want to feel interrupted. So imagine the closer the system gets to being perceived as a trusted assistant, of course, the more sensitive monetization becomes. Right?

People expect help, relevance, coherence, much more. So the future of retail media is, for me, unlikely to be a simple copy paste of search ads into an AI interface. So

that's also another challenge. Instead, I think it will likely become something closer to contextual influence within this reasoning flow that we've been talking.

So this could mean, for example, I'd say embedded recommendations, scenario based offers, commercially influenced suggestions within different moments and different modes of the journey, but this need to feel useful, relevant, and sincere, not intrusive.

So I see already those commercial models emerging, by the way. Premium AI ad pricing, new formats, sponsors, integration, transaction linked models, all are coming actually. They're different models and tests. But I think everything depends on one key condition, preserving trust. So that's the the most important difference I think it will come.

Yeah. I I I agree. So, you know, what made most agents and I'm not talking just about, you know, Sparky and and Rufus, like, beyond that Evolve so fast is that element of trust, like, you know, independence. And this is my thinking companion partner back to the first, like, question we discussed.

So yeah. So it's like there is a balancing or there is a really kind of arbitrage question, which is, like, if we replicate the old format with the media, would we lose that independence? If we do, like, shoppers will react to that. So I think I I don't know the answer, obviously, but I think it will evolve.

So but I think an initial question we should try to answer, which is, like, how many purchase purchases today are influenced by agents? I don't know. Like, at of course, it differs between categories. Like, there are some numbers that are available around thirty per one thirds are being, you know, AI influenced, and I'm sure it varies a lot between the different categories.



So I think the old format still exists, didn't disappear. So we are in that phase where, like, two things are coexisting, and I'm sure it will coexist for very long.

And I think, you know, there is a new channel with a lot of traffic that will have to be monetized in a way. So, yeah, there are few formats that we see emerging. But I think the critical difference that will happen as we see some models of retail media implemented into agent ecommerce would be about what it means for brands. It means that we are moving from buying clicks into buying to be listed as a recommendation.

And that's, like, a very different process. It's not any more linear. It's more complex, and it adds the points that Faiza was talking about, which is the context. A lot more around the context. So so it's I know, like, it's it's we don't know, but we can see directionally how all of this is going and and how it will potentially work.

I'm I'm, again, reflecting on my own habits and how they're changing. Right? Because, yeah, indeed, like, I had a whole I have a whole new skincare routine that's a hundred percent Tadzipity designed, but I did zero purchases through Tadzipity.

Yeah. I'm not you can use it. No one like you dot com.

Yeah. I mean, like Especially now.

With the care routine.

But how much is of of that is captured. Right? Because all these things are creating some kind of relationship that I will have with L'Oreal brands, for example. Right?

Just because I'm going to get a direction on what I'm going to look even on the physical self. And this is definitely not captured on the thirty percent that you mentioned, Selim. And I was wondering, like, Beza, I would love to hear your point of

view on, like, everybody, as I mentioned, was talking about Adjentic in ShopTalk. Right? So it's in everybody's radar. Everybody's trying to do something.

What is the one thing that you believe most companies are getting wrong today? Like, what should they change?

That's one of the favorite question of mine. So stop me if I'm gonna be very philosophical. You know? This is this question dear to my heart.

So the first mistake, I think, is treating this as hype. That's, I would say, a mindset mistake or just the marketing tech evolution. It is not. It's a fundamental human behavior shift.

It's about delegating of cognitive work, thinking, deciding to systems. And it goes beyond ecommerce. Right? It's a lifestyle change.

So I think that's, first of all, one thing that we need to digest. And second one, I would say is organizational. Because companies treat this as a silo, a marketing project, a fine part of the journey project, a tech project, an innovation topic, but it touches everything, data, content, tech, governance, and organizational design. Right?

And there's also one other thing that keeps me awake, I would say, at night when you think from that one, but what is the real constraint? Let's say you were you come through that. Right? So the the key question for me, on what basis will consumers actually, are consumers trusting these systems enough to delegate meaningful decisions and actions?

Trust includes quality, transparency, you know, source credibility, explainability, neutral neutrality, governance. Because once AI moves from, helper to decision partner, it becomes more than a tool. The moment AI becomes a decision layer, it becomes a power layer, and it becomes a shaped environment. And then the question becomes, who designed it?

Right? And whose incentives are inside it? How transparent are those incentives? And increasingly, who actually shapes the answer the consumer sees and what protects the consumer?

That's why the biggest constraint for me is not the technology, and it's not, I would say, the mindset because I'm sure we will come to that level or organizational shift. I think it's the trust design. And it's for sure, AI is not only mediating commerce or marketing environment. It starts to mediate reality.

So that's why I think there are some parts that we misunderstand or not understand clearly, but there are some things that we need to spend more time on collectively, I would say.

Yeah. So I'll just comment a few things.

So you mentioned earlier, Christine, you know, that we don't know, like, the connect between the purchase and how I was influenced. Actually, we do. So I can just share with whom I'm very interested some kind of data points we have where we you see, like, conversation and then followed up by a by an act to purchase or an add to basket. So and we know, like, this is kind of highly influenced. I think in terms of mistake, I would say first one is obviously continuing to optimize for human browsing.

And and I guess, like, I'm I'm sure I'm not wrong on this. Like, ninety nine point ninety nine percent of brands are still doing, like, you know, optimizing for human brain.

But it's hard to kind of start somewhere, so I appreciate the challenge. And I agree on the organizational challenge. So I think pre agentic, we were already putting this as a major challenge, which is the silos within organizations. So, you know, even when you were basically optimizing your digital shelf, as an ecommerce manager, you had to be very close to your store teams, to your supply chain, to your finance, to your IT, and so on and so forth. So I think we could survive without it, and we survived to now.

But I think with agent ecommerce, it's gonna be critical to break those silos once for all.

And I think bringing, like, all these teams together, including, like, product data, like, all the elements, every single part of the organization that has access to data and data that is potentially used to train LLMs, at some point, it needs to be unified. And to unify data, these are, like, huge projects that we haven't kind of addressed, I would say, a very, very serious serious manner in my point of view.

And the data needs to be real time, and back to basis point, needs to be trusted, like, at different layers to a point where we know what is whatever it's fed to these LLMs. It's like, we can trust what's going to get out of my data lakes.

So I would like let's let's flip it to the other side. So we've seen we've talked about, like, what FMCG companies are doing wrong. Let's give them let's give them some good stuff.

We've given actually, we've given them a lot of good stuff already. They're like some takeaways. Sorry. And I ask you to quickly say maybe two things that people that work in ecommerce and a brand could do today to start, like to, like, work on being more visible and be more, I think, relevant and agentic.

And then we'll go into some questions from the audience. So so, Salim, for example, do you want to give me, like, two things that you'd recommend brands to do today?

As you can imagine with my role, data.

So I would say data and two keywords, structured and centralized.

It's the moment. Like, the moment is critical because senior leadership is knows this is super important. It's potentially the moment to unlock some budgets because, like, all eyes are on the story of agentic. So every dream could have could become a

reality now that you can unlock some budget and start to work really on a on a structured data unified, you know, clean, not only for agentic, but also for insights, speed of, like, actionability, and so on and so forth.

And I would say the second thing, which is harder to tackle because it's human linked, is the ways of working. So who owns? Who governs? Who takes the action?

How do we flow the information? I'm a strong believer that data is is a is an important element, probably the most important element to a closer collaboration between Deepgram and all other different parts of the organization. So I think the two points I just mentioned are very interconnected. One feeds the other.

You can't collaborate if you don't agree on the data, if you're not talking about the same language.

And you can't kind of unify your data if you don't put people around the table to agree on who's gonna do what and who's gonna own and what is going to be our governance model. So I'm excited, like, with the with what's gonna happen in the next few months and and years because, yeah, I think it will change our way of thinking, our way of working, and potentially to a to a better to a better kind of world where we go faster, where we, you know, compete harder, and, like, live data becomes more important. Like, all these topics are very exciting for me.

Be Beza, two takeaways for brands.

He says already. So it's difficult to be second on the on this question, but, okay, I will try my best. So, definitely, I would say ways of working and data structure, obviously. But now to say something different, I can say signal coherence because if you're not consistent and coherent across the ecosystem, actually, you're not trusted and you're not gonna be eligible and recommendable. And second one, I would say contextual relevance because products need to define not only but what what they are, but what

they sold for whom in which situations. So I think that's also the two things I would add on top of the first ones, which is the ways of working and structuring the data and machine readable.

Fantastic. Fantastic.

Danielle, I see I don't coming in.

Yeah. Have you seen them come in? Because I have as well. By the way, I recommend to anyone that's listening to this afterwards too. We'll leave the link of the LinkedIn live so you can look at the comments. There's even been a bit of a debate already between Joe and Adrienne, which has been very interesting. I'll ask you for brevity answering these questions so we can go as many as we can, which Joe was asking, how do you see brands being trusted in the agentic world, like brand security, brand verification, and brand impersonation?

He doesn't see discuss that much.

I can I can I can try? I'm trying to read also the the different and the debate that is happening on the on the on the comment. So I don't know if we're talking about, like, control over the content.

Don't know if he if this is, like, the topic we're trying to do and the risks that it brings that some of the content is not rated.

If if that is the question, I think, you know, keeping an eye so you remember, we had those kind of roles where you you're supposed to go on Reddit and check, you know, what is being discussed and give answers to shoppers. You know, it comes I think this becomes now super important roles, you know, to kind of course correct if there is a a wrong statement said about your brands. And I'm sure these roles still exist. But, yeah, I think, like, owning, understanding, and and making sure, like, you correct and you answer to your shoppers. I don't know to what extent, like, other kind of

forums will be will be also impacted. But but, yeah, it's I think, like, it's it's making sure that your shopper questions are being kind of addressed. You can't control what people say, but you can answer to them.

And it's same, like, the same diligence as we do on the ratings and reviews in different websites, like, when we make sure that we're addressing the kind of review. So I don't know if it addresses the question.

Well, I think it it actually answers another question from Filiberto, which is, like, how do you prevent competitors from deliberately damaging your recommendability? And I think it's that. No. Like, don't be afraid to, like, be part of the conversation.

No. I think that I think there's the one. Another one that came from hold on. Just a minute.

Second. Santiago who's asking, do you believe we are moving from share of shelf and share of search to a new metric like share of recommendation, and how should companies measure that?

Yeah. So the way I I we're working on this is more share of conversation.

And I know Visa has a a different terminology also. So I I I love to call it share of conversations. So the way I we're working on this is, you know, in conversations within a given category, what is me as a brand, my share of conversation around that topic. And for me, like, when you double click on this, like, let's say, my share of conversation is thirty percent, then I can go deeper and say and see what are the most popular topics being discussed on conversations in my category.

And once I know this, then I get out with a very actionable insight, which is I need to optimize in a contextual way my product pages and product content on the most popular topics. So, you know, if I am on the toothpaste category and whitening is a topic, then I'll probably take my range that is more on the whitening and claim that

more. Or if all my products are you know, could benefit from that claim, I could do it on my entire range. Just having that reflections, like, what's my share of recommendation?

How can I improve it by understanding, you know, the what shoppers are talking about and conversing about? And once I know that, then I can start to take the actions on my PDP and on my broader content. It's a very maybe simplistic way, but I think it's actionable. Like, I'm very obsessed about how can you convert quickly, like, a data point into an action and iterate on it and see the results.

If you're improving your share of conversation, then you must be doing something right. If you are not improving, then you must must be looking, like, deeper on other topics, other patterns from the conversations that we have.

You're gonna be surprised, but I totally agree. So let me do because I this is actionable today.

Did you guys speak before we started recording?

No. We did. But this this this so before you answer, these are the conversations we have with Beza for more than a year now.

Yeah.

So that's why I I was saying it to be I was happy that we're having this live in front of.

Yeah. I just wanna add something, you know, but it's more, again, in a more philosophical level, it stays at this stage. But if recommendation becomes the gate, you know, the conversation becomes the gate, trust becomes then the filter afterwards. So that's why I keep on saying beyond all that, the next real metric today, we're not, capable of, measuring it, but we should consider measuring is the share of trust because recommendation only matters if people trust the system enough to



follow it. Right? But indeed, it is not practical today. Today, we're barely managing the share of conversation and share of recommendation.

Maybe one day we should work on it.

I have to say, I think from this whole conversation today, if we had the bingo card, trust would be the word that we have used most. Like, this is what I'm with me, please.

Yeah. Absolutely.

Yeah. And it's I mean, look. I mean, I think that we it's one of the topics that has so many tangents. So maybe we can do another one soon. No? Yes.

Because the because the no. Because then you have trust built through, like, influencers and and traditional marketing. And whether you put one and the other. We didn't even like, one of the things that we were I think, we'll leave it as an open end in case somebody wants to ask you guys, they can reach that directly. Like, I don't know, brand web brand website which has been largely neglected by FMCGs, but has become seemingly more relevant than ever. So just so many topics, but I think we we got the most of the time. So thanks Salim and Beza for joining us.

Thank you so much.

Thank you very much.

And thanks Thank you, guys.

Thanks to the audience as well for tuning in. Love the debate that I was seeing on my second screen, which is actually my phone since when when when we were having this conversation. It's obviously a a great topic, so thanks everyone for joining. Remember, you can continue listening to us on the FMCG. Guys, and actually, Salim

and I already have another day to do a webinar on April sixteenth, which will be all about data piece. And we already have a confirmed speaker for that from Henkel. So very excited about that.

Excellent. I will join Jason. Thank you so much.

Perfect. We'll wait for your questions. Thanks, everyone.

Thank you. Thank you, Faiza.

Bye. Thank you. Bye.

Bye bye.